



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Authorship & Intellectual Contribution Policy

Document ID: ZSMC-POL-001 Rev 0

Effective Date: 16-08-2026

Evidence before prestige. Reproducibility before publicity. Intellectual contribution before title. Scientific honesty before institutional interest.

This policy establishes how intellectual contributions to ZSMC research are recognized, documented, and attributed.

The policy is intended to ensure that authorship and scientific credit reflect actual intellectual contribution rather than organizational position, seniority, personal relationships, funding status, or title.

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Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



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Scope

This policy applies to all research outputs produced wholly or partly under the affiliation of The ZSMC Co., including:

- research papers;
- technical reports;
- conference publications;
- datasets;
- software and computational research;
- research protocols;
- substantial technical documentation; and
- other scholarly outputs where attribution is appropriate.

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Fundamental Principles

Authorship shall be determined by **substantive intellectual contribution** to the relevant work.

Holding an organizational title shall not, by itself, establish authorship.

The following do not automatically confer authorship:

- being Founder;
- being Lead Researcher;
- being a Research Advisor;
- providing funding;
- providing laboratory space;
- providing administrative assistance;
- being a senior or junior member;
- being affiliated with ZSMC; or
- being associated with the organization in another capacity.

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Recognized Contributions

Relevant intellectual contributions may include:

- conception or substantial refinement of the research question;
- development of significant theoretical or computational methods;
- substantial experimental design;
- substantial engineering design;
- acquisition of important research data through meaningful research work;
- substantial analysis or interpretation of results;
- development of significant software or computational infrastructure integral to the research;
- substantial drafting of the research output;
- substantial critical revision that contributes intellectual content.

Routine administrative, logistical, financial, or supervisory assistance does not ordinarily constitute authorship by itself.

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Contribution Records

For significant research projects, contributors should maintain a record of their substantive contributions.

Where appropriate, research outputs should include a contribution statement identifying the nature of each contributor's work.

Contributions may be recorded using standardized contributor terminology where appropriate.

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Authorship Discussions

For significant research projects, contributors should maintain a record of their substantive contributions.

Where appropriate, research outputs should include a contribution statement identifying the nature of each contributor's work.

Contributions may be recorded using standardized contributor terminology where appropriate.

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Author Order

Where author order is relevant, it shall be determined by the contributors based primarily on the nature and extent of intellectual contribution and the conventions applicable to the research field.

ZSMC shall not impose a universal author-order rule across all disciplines.

Where appropriate, the basis for author order may be documented.

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Non-Author Contributions

Important contributions that do not meet the applicable authorship threshold should be acknowledged appropriately.

Examples may include:

- laboratory assistance;
- equipment access;
- administrative support;
- general supervision;
- funding;
- data provision;
- technical assistance; or
- advisory discussion without substantial intellectual contribution.

Acknowledgment shall not be used as a substitute for authorship where a contributor actually meets the applicable authorship criteria.

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Research Advisors

Appointment as a ZSMC Research Advisor does not automatically confer authorship.

An advisor who makes a substantive intellectual contribution may qualify for authorship in accordance with this policy.

An advisor who provides only general guidance, institutional support, or occasional feedback should ordinarily be acknowledged rather than listed as an author.

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Software and Computational Contributions

For computational research, substantial contributions to algorithms, implementation, experimental design, analysis, validation, or interpretation may constitute intellectual contributions relevant to authorship.

Use of software, libraries, computing resources, or standard tools does not automatically establish authorship.

Third-party software shall be credited and licensed appropriately.

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Disputes

Authorship disagreements should first be addressed among the relevant contributors through good-faith discussion.

Where disagreement cannot be resolved internally, ZSMC may seek independent advice from an appropriately qualified researcher or institution.

No person shall use organizational authority solely to obtain or deny authorship.

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Changes After Publication

If a significant authorship or contribution error is discovered after publication, ZSMC shall seek an appropriate correction through the relevant publisher, repository, or public record.

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Responsibilities

All contributors are responsible for:

- accurately representing their own contributions;
- recognizing the contributions of others;
- raising authorship concerns in good faith;
- maintaining appropriate contribution records; and
- complying with relevant publisher or venue requirements.

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Review

This policy shall be reviewed as ZSMC's research activities and collaborative structures develop.

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